

IXD803 CA1 — EMPATHIZE & DEFINE

TOURGUIDE

Connecting Tourists with Local Tour Guides

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1. Choose a Problem

Problem selected: Finding and booking reliable local tour guides when travelling to a new city, state or country.

Travelling to an unfamiliar destination can be exciting, but tourists may not know which places are worth visiting, how to reach them, what local customs to follow, or whether a guide is trustworthy. At the same time, local guides can find it difficult to reach tourists and manage bookings.

Why this problem matters

- Tourists may struggle to find a trusted local guide.
- Prices and services may not be clear before booking.
- Tourists may have difficulty comparing guides.
- Communication and meeting-location coordination can be difficult.
- Local guides need a way to become discoverable and manage bookings.



Photo 1

2. Understand the Users

The project uses primary-research activities such as observation and direct interaction with users, supported by secondary research. The uploaded field photos document interaction/observation in a real environment. The research focus is to understand how tourists and local guides discover services, communicate, compare options and arrange tours.

Primary Research

- Observation: Observe how people discuss travel, destinations, guides and tour arrangements.

- Interviews: Ask tourists how they normally find guides, what information they need before booking, and what creates trust.
- Interviews with guides: Ask how they currently find tourists, manage availability and handle bookings.
- Use actual responses from participants when completing the interview findings; do not invent responses.

Secondary Research

Existing travel and tourism platforms can be studied for common user expectations such as destination search, ratings and reviews, booking systems, location-based discovery, price information and personalized recommendations.



Photo 2

3. Find Pain Points

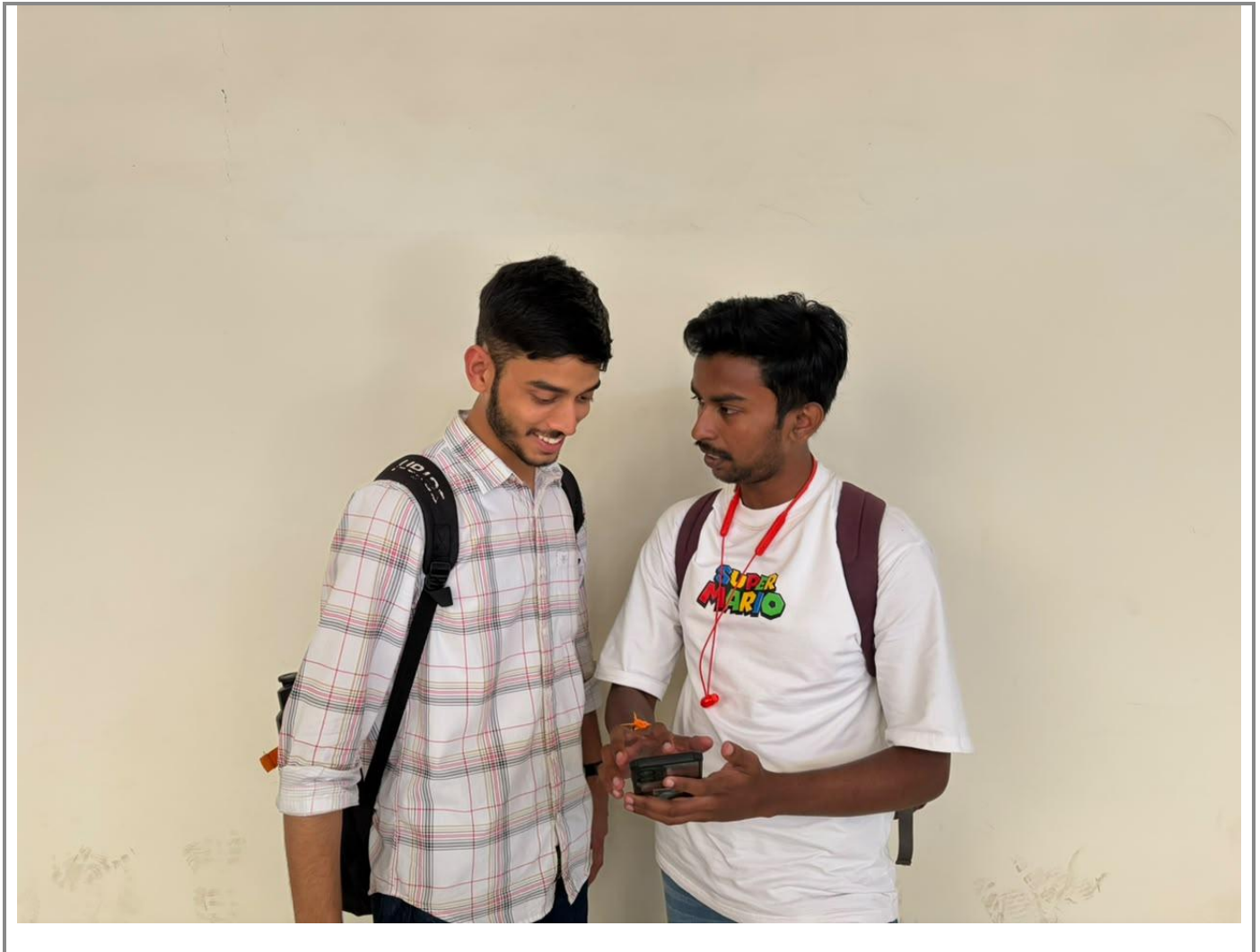
Tourist Pain Points

- Difficulty finding a reliable and trusted guide.
- Uncertainty about guide prices and services.
- Lack of information about experience, languages and specialization.
- Difficulty comparing multiple guides.
- Language and communication barriers.
- Difficulty planning a personalized trip.
- Concerns about scams or unreliable services.
- Difficulty coordinating meeting locations and tour timings.

Guide Pain Points

- Difficulty reaching tourists directly.
- Dependence on local agents or personal contacts.

- Irregular bookings.
- No centralized profile for services.
- Difficulty managing availability and bookings.



4. Define Your Users

Primary User Group 1 — Tourists

Solo travellers, couples, families, students and groups visiting a destination who want convenient access to local knowledge and guidance.

- Needs: trusted guides, transparent pricing, easy booking, safety, communication and personalized experiences.
- Goals: discover places, compare guides, book conveniently and enjoy a guided experience.

Primary User Group 2 — Local Tour Guides

Professional guides, freelance guides and knowledgeable local residents who want to connect with tourists and manage their services digitally.

- Needs: visibility, booking opportunities, profile management, availability management and communication.
- Goals: reach tourists, receive bookings and build a reputation through reviews.

User Persona — Tourist

- Name: Rahul Sharma
- Age: 24
- Occupation: Student
- Travel Type: Solo Traveller
- Goals: Explore famous and hidden places; find an affordable and trustworthy guide; have a safe experience; learn about local culture and history.
- Pain Points: Cannot easily compare guides; uncertainty about guide reliability; unclear pricing; difficulty planning places to visit.

User Persona — Tour Guide

- Name: Arjun Singh
- Age: 32
- Occupation: Local Tour Guide
- Goals: Get more tourists; increase bookings; showcase local knowledge; build a reputation through reviews.
- Pain Points: Depends on local agents; difficult to reach tourists directly; irregular bookings; no centralized profile for services.



5. Create a User Journey

Stage	User Action	Pain Point	Design Opportunity
Discover	Search for a destination	Too much information	Simple destination discovery
Explore	View attractions	Does not know what to choose	Organized place information
Find Guide	Search available guides	Trust is uncertain	Verified guide profiles
Compare	Check profiles, prices and services	Different prices/services	Clear comparison information
Book	Select date and time	Availability unclear	Availability calendar
Connect	Chat with the guide	Communication issues	In-app chat
Visit	Meet the guide	Location confusion	Meeting-point details
Review	Rate the guide	Feedback not centralized	Rating and review system



6. Write a Problem Statement

Tourists visiting unfamiliar destinations often struggle to find trustworthy local guides, understand and compare their services and prices, and coordinate bookings. They need a simple way to discover guides, view relevant information, compare options, select a suitable date and time, communicate with the guide and review the experience.

At the same time, local guides need a way to become visible to tourists and manage their profiles, availability and bookings. Therefore, TourGuide is proposed as a centralized platform connecting tourists and local guides through destination discovery, transparent guide information, booking, communication and reviews.

Design Challenge

How might we create a trusted and convenient platform that helps tourists discover, compare and book local tour guides while helping guides find and manage tourists easily?

Final UX Goal

Choose a place → Discover guides → Compare → Book → Connect → Explore

Research Questions for Real Users

Questions for Tourists

- How do you normally find guides when travelling?
- Have you ever hired a local guide?
- What problems did you face?
- What information would you want before booking?
- How important are ratings and reviews?
- Would you prefer booking a guide through an app?
- What information would make you trust a guide?
- Would you prefer hourly, half-day or full-day guides?

Questions for Tour Guides

- How do you currently find tourists?
- How do tourists contact you?
- What problems do you face with bookings?
- How do you manage availability?
- Would an online platform help you get customers?
- What information should tourists see before booking?